

8. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-01054

CASE NAME: SLIVER'S, LLC VS. CL LA FIESTA SQUARE CA LP

**HEARING ON SUMMARY MOTION DEPT 16 NOTE: MSJ PAPERWORK TO BE FILED ON 12/1
FILED BY:**

TENTATIVE RULING:

This Tentative Ruling applies to Lines 8, 9, and 10. On May 26, 2026, the Parties represented to the Court that they have reached a settlement in principle and have requested to take this hearing off calendar. No appearance is required on June 3, 2026.

The Court sets an Order to Show Cause re Dismissal for September 28, 2026 at 8:30 a.m. to follow-up on the settlement. That date may be vacated by stipulation, or the by the filing of a request for dismissal.

9. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-01054

CASE NAME: SLIVER'S, LLC VS. CL LA FIESTA SQUARE CA LP

***HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: SEAL UNREDACTED MOTION FOR SUMMARY ADJUDICATION**

FILED BY: SLIVER'S, LLC

TENTATIVE RULING:

See Line 8

10. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-01054

CASE NAME: SLIVER'S, LLC VS. CL LA FIESTA SQUARE CA LP

***HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: SEAL DEFENDANTS' UN-REDACTED MOTION FOR SUMMARY
JUDGMENT (ADVANCED FROM 8/19/26)**

FILED BY: SLIVER'S, LLC

TENTATIVE RULING:

See Line 8.

11. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-01877

CASE NAME: ZACHARY MINOR VS. CRAIG HOWARD

***HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: FOR EVIDENTIARY SANCTIONS AND TO EXCLUDE IMPROPERLY
WITHHELD "SETTLEMOIR FINANCIALS"**

FILED BY: MINOR, ZACHARY

TENTATIVE RULING:

Summary

Plaintiffs Zachary and Angela Minor ("Plaintiff") filed a Motion in Limine for Evidentiary Sanctions and to Exclude Improperly Withheld "Settlevoirs Financials" against Defendant Craig Howard. This motion is **dismissed** without prejudice as premature and this hearing is **vacated**.. The Court has not set a trial date in this case and it is improper to hear a motion in limine at this stage of the proceedings. Moreover, there is no proof of service form evidencing that Defendant was served with this Motion.

Plaintiff's "reply brief" mentioned that plaintiffs relied on legal interpretation from court staff pertaining to the filing of this motion. Plaintiffs are admonished that they should seek legal advice

from a licensed attorney and not from court staff. Plaintiffs may bring this motion pursuant to the Court's pre-trial orders when Motions in Limine are requested by the Court.

No appearance is required at the hearing on June 3, 2026.

12. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C25-00261
CASE NAME: KIKI BROWS VS. RAMANUJAN GROUP LLC
***HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: BE RELIEVED AS COUNSEL**

FILED BY:

TENTATIVE RULING:

Summary

Defendant Ramanujan Group LLC's ("Defendant") counsel, Kutak Rock LLP, and Brian J. Wagner, Esq.'s ("Withdrawing Counsel") filed a Motion to Be Relieved as Counsel for Defendant ("Motion") on February 3, 2026. The Motion is **granted** as set forth herein. No appearance is required on June 3, 2026.

Background

Plaintiff Kiki Brows alleges a breach of contract, fraud and reliance causes of action by Defendant related to a lease of business premises located at 3570 Blackhawk Plaza Cir., C-04A, Danville, California. Withdrawing Counsel filed a Motion to Be Relieved as Counsel for Defendant, supported by his declaration claiming that irreconcilable differences and a breakdown of attorney client relationship has occurred. Withdrawing Counsel can no longer represent Defendant.

Analysis

Cal. Rules of Court Rule No. 3.1362 and Cal. Code of Civ. Proc. §§284(1) and (2) sets forth the standard and procedure to be relieved as counsel of record. The Code permits an attorney to be changed at any time before or after judgment or final determination "upon the consent of both client and attorney," or "upon order of the court, upon the application of either client or attorney, after notice from one to the other." Defendant's Counsel has complied with the provisions of this rule and statute providing notice to Plaintiff and supporting this motion with a declaration articulating the reasons for withdrawal.

The Court finds that there is good cause to grant this Motion to relieve Withdrawing Counsel. The Court acknowledges that the prejudice to Defendant is minimal, as there is ample time for Defendant to retain trial counsel. No trial date has been set and no dispositive motions are currently on calendar.

Ruling

After reviewing the papers and arguments submitted by counsel and after considering and weighing the prejudice to both sides, and reviewing the relevant statutory and decisional authority, the Court finds that there is good cause to grant the Motion of Withdrawing Counsel to be Relieved as Counsel of Record. The makes the following orders: